

AI water usage is actually not as harmful as what I once thought, but I also think that limiting the amount of data centers is crucial as well

Posted by u/Alternative_Ride_951 • • 0 points • 12 comments

Source: <https://www.eesi.org/articles/view/data-centers-and-water-consumption>

I'm relieved to find out that the water is evaporated and thus given back to nature so we still have sufficient water. However, I also believe that limiting the amount of data centers is also crucial, because in this video: <https://youtu.be/ModWqgKMz4k?si=OiXqXEVwZ1-sAloP> shows that people who live near data centers can't get enough water in their homes. I do think that AI should be accessible to the public but the data centers should be built far away from homes and there should only be a few data centers so people can still get enough water while also still being able to use AI. What are your thoughts on this? I also agree with the other environmentally friendly ways this website listed for water usage.

Comments

u/-TV-Stand- • 1 points • 2026-01-22 01:30 UTC

Here they like to use sea water or heat up homes using district heating with the waste heat

u/SweetCommieTears • 3 points • 2026-01-21 21:02 UTC

\>I'm relieved to find out that the water is evaporated and thus given back to nature so we still have sufficient water

Antis out there just learning about the water cycle. Lmao.

Anyway, to your other point. That is not an AI problem, that's an US problem which also happens with industrial farms.

u/Alternative_Ride_951 • 1 points • 2026-01-21 21:10 UTC

I already knew about the water cycle, I just didn't know how the AI water cooling thing worked.

u/crossorbital • 1 points • 2026-01-21 20:30 UTC

Data centers are going to be built regardless. That's not inherently bad.

What needs to happen is governments, from the local to national level, need to fucking stop bending over and letting corporations fuck the citizens raw. No handouts, no tax breaks, no favors. Force the data centers to pay their own way and forbid them from overtaxing local resources.

Like 99% of the problems associated with AI would magically go away if the government was willing to shove a spiked dildo up the collective ass of big tech. That's what everyone should be focused on.

u/Alternative_Ride_951 • 1 points • 2026-01-21 20:31 UTC

That's a really good point. You're definitely correct about that.

u/hot_sauce_in_coffee • 3 points • 2026-01-21 19:17 UTC

Just require data center to built next to nuclear power plan or hydro source or solar source.

All of those electricity production always have more capacity near where they produce it and loss electricity along the power grid simply due to copper limitation.

If it end up pushing people to build more nuclear and more solar and more hydro, it's also a good thing for the rest of the world and the environment.

u/ChildOfChimps • 4 points • 2026-01-21 18:57 UTC

It's like this - people are right when they say the water argument isn't one that really means anything. I think the real problem is having them too close to towns and neighborhoods, because they aren't exactly good for the local environment in more ways than just the water thing.

u/PaperSweet9983 • 2 points • 2026-01-21 19:30 UTC

Yes. And they're also in the wrong climate

<https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/nearly-7000-of-the-worlds-data-centers-are-built-in-the-wrong-climate>

u/-TV-Stand- • 1 points • 2026-01-22 01:32 UTC

Some data centers need to be located near the users but AI datacenters don't

u/Sekhmet-CustosAurora • 6 points • 2026-01-21 18:46 UTC

Just limit where they can build data centers that aren't using closed-loop cooling lol. limiting data center construction in general is a really great way to hand AGI to China

u/Alternative_Ride_951 • 5 points • 2026-01-21 18:46 UTC

Yeah this is true I never considered this

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2026-01-21 18:42 UTC

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